

A USER MANUAL · VERSION 1.0

Pomodoro TIMER

A glass timer that sits at the edge of your screen and keeps you working in focused rounds. This manual shows you how to install it, use it and make it yours.

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01 · OVERVIEW CORE

Focus made SIMPLE

Pomodoro splits your work into short rounds with breaks in between. The app runs the clock so you can think about the work.

A widget on the edge

Dock it to **any side** of the screen and drag it along that edge. It never opens a window.

Time in the menu bar

The clock icon shows the **time left** and opens settings and statistics.

Your own numbers

It counts sessions and tells you how many ran **without interruption**.

The idea in 30 seconds

You work for one **session** (25 minutes by default), then take a short **break** (5 minutes). After four sessions you get a longer break (15 minutes). That is one cycle. You can change every length in the settings.

YOU NEED

- macOS 27 or later for the downloaded app
- About two minutes to set it up

IT LIVES IN

- A widget on a screen edge
- The menu bar
- No Dock icon

IT KEEPS

- Settings and statistics on your Mac only
- Nothing on a server

You never need a window. After launch you will see the widget at the left edge of the screen and a clock in the menu bar. That is the whole app.

02 · INSTALLING ONCE

Getting STARTED

Five steps, and you only do them once per Mac.

1 **Download the app.** Open the **Releases** page of the project on GitHub and download `Pomodoro-v1.0-macOS.zip` from the latest release.

2 **Unzip it.** Double-click the zip file. You get `Pomodoro.app`.

3 **Move it to Applications.** Drag `Pomodoro.app` into the **Applications** folder. Starting at login works best from there.

4 **Open it with a right-click.** Right-click `Pomodoro.app`, choose **Open**, then **Open** again in the dialog. macOS asks this once because the app is not from the App Store.

5 **Allow notifications.** When macOS asks, click **Allow**. You will get a banner at the end of every session and break.

macOS says it cannot open the app? Go to **System Settings › Privacy & Security**, scroll down and click **Open Anyway** next to Pomodoro. This is normal for apps that are not signed with an Apple developer certificate.

If macOS still blocks it

Remove the download flag from the app. Open **Terminal** and paste:

```
TERMINAL
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/Pomodoro.app
```

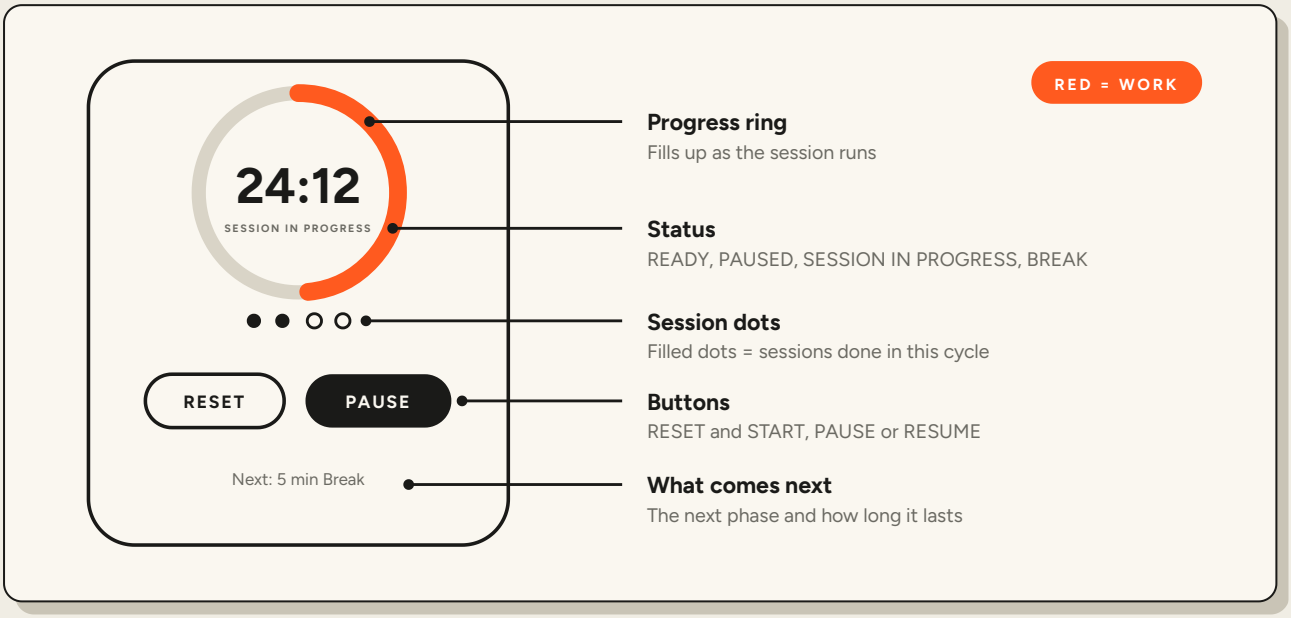
What you should see

No window opens. The **widget** appears at the left edge of the screen, and a **clock icon** appears in the menu bar. If both are there, you are done.

03 · THE WIDGET CORE

Meet the WIDGET

Everything you need during work is on one small glass panel.



Work sessions are tinted red. Breaks turn the whole widget teal, so you can tell at a glance which phase you are in.

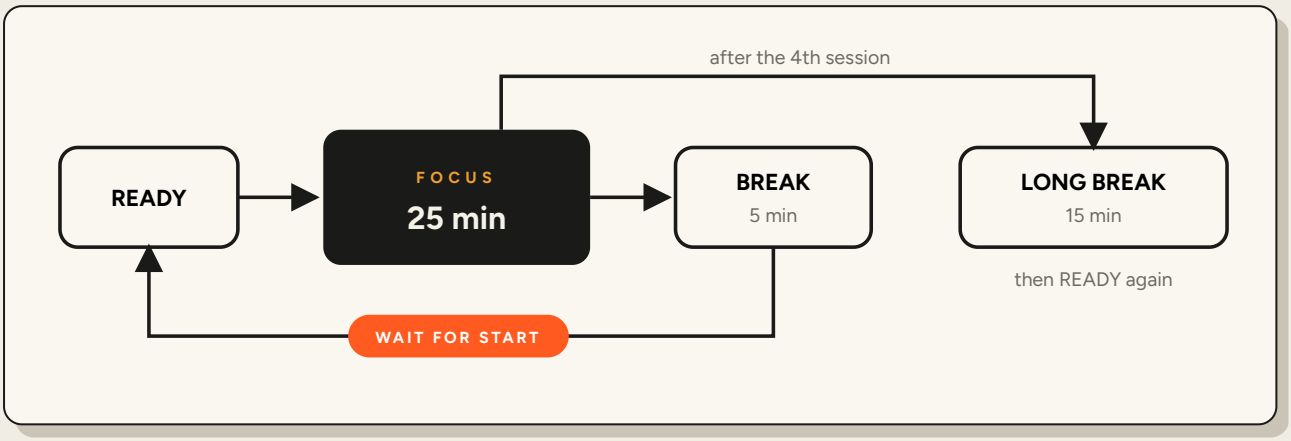
Controls

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
START	Starts the countdown from the ready state.
PAUSE / RESUME	Holds the clock and continues it. A pause during a work session counts as an interruption.
RESET	Stops the current phase and returns to **READY**.
Drag	Grab the background, ring or labels and slide the widget along its edge. The position is remembered for each edge.

04 · WORK AND REST CORE

Work and REST

One cycle is four work sessions, each followed by a break, with a longer break at the end.



A break begins by itself. A new work session always waits until you press START.

What happens, step by step

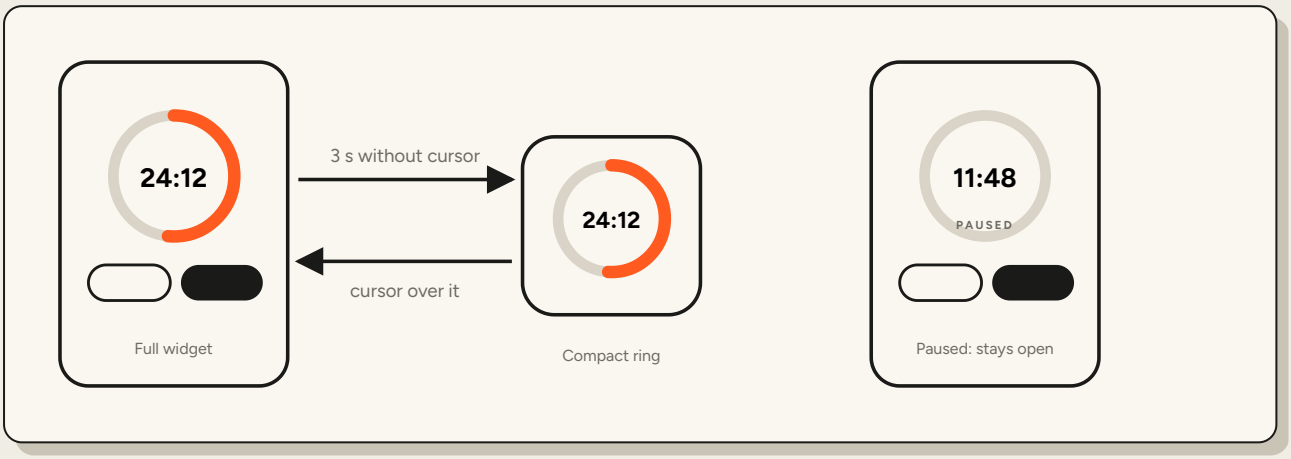
1. **Press START.** The ring fills and the status reads SESSION IN PROGRESS.
2. **The session ends.** You hear a soft chime, get a **Session complete** banner, and the break starts on its own. The widget turns teal.
3. **The break ends.** A second chime plays with a **Break is over** banner. The widget goes back to **READY** and waits for you.
4. **After four sessions** the break is the long one. After it, the dots reset and a new cycle begins.

Long break turned off? Set it to 0 in the settings. After the fourth session you get a normal break, and the next START begins a new cycle.

05 · COMPACT MODE EXTENDED

Out of the WAY

When you are not using the widget, it shrinks to a small ring with the time. Move the cursor over it and it opens again.



While the timer runs, or is ready to start, the widget shrinks by itself. A paused widget stays open, as a reminder to resume.

When it collapses

STATE	BEHAVIOUR
Running	Collapses after 3 seconds without the cursor on it.
Ready to start	Collapses after 3 seconds without the cursor on it.
Paused	Stays open. This is a nudge to press RESUME.
After launch	Starts collapsed right away. It opens when you point at it.

Prefer it always open? Turn off **Compact mode** in the settings. To keep only the collapsing but skip the collapsed start, turn off **Start collapsed after launch**.

06 · SETTINGS CORE

Make it YOURS

Click the **clock icon** in the menu bar. A small panel opens with every option.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Session	Length of a work session, 1 to 180 minutes. Default 25.
Break	Length of a normal break, 1 to 60 minutes. Default 5.
Long break	Length of the long break after every 4 sessions, 0 to 60 minutes in steps of 5. Default 15. Set it to 0 to turn it off.
Size reduction	Shrinks the widget by 0 to 50 %. Default 25 %.
Screen edge	Left, right, top or bottom edge.
Show time in menu bar	Prints the time left next to the clock icon while a phase runs.
Compact mode (auto-collapse)	Lets the widget shrink when you are not using it.
Start collapsed after launch	The widget starts as a small ring. Works only with Compact mode on.
Center widget on edge	Moves the widget back to the middle of the current edge.
Launch at login	Opens Pomodoro every time you log in to your Mac.
Quit Pomodoro	Closes the app. You can also press ⌘ Q while the panel is open.

Changes apply at once. In the ready state the new length shows immediately. During a session or break the new value starts with the next phase.

07 · STATISTICS CORE

Know your NUMBERS

The panel under the settings counts your work sessions. Breaks are not counted.

NUMBER	WHAT IT MEANS
Total sessions	How many work sessions were recorded.
Without interruption	The share of sessions you finished without pausing or resetting.
Average length	The average time you actually worked in a session.

What counts as an interruption

- A **pause** during a work session marks that session as interrupted, even if you resume.
- A **reset** before the end records the session as interrupted.
- Interrupted sessions shorter than **10 seconds** are ignored, so an accidental START does not spoil your numbers.
- Pausing during a break does **not** count.

Where the data lives

Statistics are stored only on your Mac, in this file:

FILE

```
~/Library/Application Support/PomodoroWidget/sessions.json
```

Reset statistics cannot be undone. The button asks you to click twice. After the second click the whole history is gone.

08 · TROUBLESHOOTING PRINT ME

Rules and ANSWERS

Find your problem in the left column. The fix is on the right.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
macOS will not open the app	Right-click the app and choose **Open**. Or use **System Settings › Privacy & Security › Open Anyway**.
I cannot see the widget	It may be collapsed to a small ring. Check the screen edge you chose, then use **Screen edge** and **Center widget on edge** in the settings.
There is no clock in the menu bar	A full menu bar can hide extra icons. Close a few menu bar apps, then check again.
No banner at the end of a session	Open **System Settings › Notifications › Pomodoro** and allow notifications.
No sound at the end of a session	Check the Mac volume and the selected output device. The sound comes from the app, not from the system notification sound.
The notification has a blank icon	Quit Pomodoro, keep one copy only in Applications, and run `killall NotificationCenter usernoted Dock Finder` in Terminal. If that is not enough, restart the Mac.
Launch at login does nothing	Keep the app in the **Applications** folder. Turn the option off and on again.
The timer is gone after I quit	Quitting stops the timer. It is not resumed when you open the app again.
Statistics look too low	A single pause marks that session as interrupted. See the Statistics section.

CHEAT SHEET PRINT ME

All on one PAGE

Widget

CONTROL	ACTION
START	Begin a session
PAUSE / RESUME	Hold or continue
RESET	Back to READY
Drag	Slide along the edge
Hover	Open a compact widget

One cycle

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
1–4	Session, then break
After 4	Long break
Break over	READY, waits for START

Defaults

SETTING	VALUE
Session	25 min
Break	5 min
Long break	15 min
Size reduction	25 %

Compact mode

STATE	WIDGET
Running	Collapses after 3 s
READY	Collapses after 3 s
Paused	Stays open
After launch	Starts collapsed

Interruptions

ACTION	COUNTED
Pause in a session	Interrupted
Reset in a session	Interrupted
Under 10 s	Ignored
Pause in a break	Not counted

Menu bar

ITEM	WHERE
Settings	Click the clock icon
Statistics	Under the settings
Quit	⌘ Q in the panel

Pomodoro Timer · version 1.0 · macOS · github.com/gen-wit/macos-pomodoro